



The Shack
Mill Road
Ballasalla
Isle of Man
IM9 2EG

Isle of Man Amateur Radio Society

Minutes of the Committee Meeting of Friday, 7th August 2026.

The Meeting opened at 19:30BST.

Apologies: None

Present: Richard GD8EXI, John GD0TFG, Robert GD0GGO, Stuart GD0OUD, and Keith GD5IOM

Secretary's Report

Correspondence was received from Gavin regarding the iomars.im domain. Gavin confirmed that the domain, website hosting, and git repository should all be held by the committee, and undertook to make a plan to transfer them accordingly.

Treasurer's Report

Total at Bank: £4,786.99

Repeater Fund: £461.83

Club funds: £4,324.16

Cash in hand: £120.35

Proceeds were received from the sale of surplus club equipment.

Bank Account Management

The committee discussed ways to minimise bank charges.

- A saving of £1.60 per transaction can be made by routing cash through John GD0TFG, who will pay the proceeds in by BACS.

The committee agreed with that proposal.

The possibility of paying the RSGB subscription by BACS was also raised.

- John GD0TFG to investigate.
- John GD0TFG to inform Chris GD6TWF, our internal auditor, of the new arrangements.

Upcoming Events

August and September schedule:

- 19 August – Ballasalla: cancelled.
- 27 August – Creg ny Baa: cancelled.
- 2 September – Ballasalla: VarAC and Meshtastic/Meshcore.
- 6 September – SOTA activations (see below).
- 16 September – Ballasalla: normal meeting.
- 24 September – Creg ny Baa: going ahead.

Members to be reminded of upcoming cancellations via WhatsApp and the newsletter.

6 September – SOTA / 2m Trophy / Backpackers Contest:

- All three events coincide, which should generate good activity.
- Good SSB activity expected; FM activity less certain but possible if many operators are out.
- Slieau Freoaghane and South Barrule are difficult summits and may not be worth attempting.
- To be promoted via the newsletter, the WhatsApp activity group, and the SOTA reflector.
- Suggested operating frequencies to be circulated to members.

Note: Richard will be back from October.

7 October – Antenna test range event:

- John GD0TFG to bring tripods.
- All members to bring antennas and feeders.
- Feeder loss to be measured – losses can be subtle: bad contacts, bad plugs, point contact instead of solid contact, suck-outs, and damaged foil coax are all worth checking.
- UR58 coax to be offered for sale; equipment store to be checked for additional items.

4 November – Testing night:

- Possible theme: receiver and LNA noise figure measurement.
- Switching off AGC on receivers to be explored.

Preamp project – to be featured in a future newsletter:

- Coax relay to form part of the project.
- Coaxial relays could be sourced from AliExpress.

Mobile Shack

The future of the mobile shack was discussed: whether to scrap it or develop it as a fixed shack.

Location:

- The land is owned by Nigel, a club member.
- The main field is large and otherwise unused; parking should not be a problem.

RF environment:

- Possible interference from a nearby power cable; moisture breaking down on the insulators is audible.
- The location has been used successfully for radio operations before.
- Richard to assess aerial takeoff angles using HeyWhatsThat.
- Noise level at the site to be measured using the marine mobile spectrum analyser.

Practical considerations:

- The shack to be tested to confirm it is still operational.
- Availability of aerals to be confirmed.
- Mast attachment brackets to be considered for the vehicle to simplify future deployments.

National Hamfest, Newark

The National Hamfest takes place at Newark Showground on Friday 25th and Saturday 26th September 2026.

- John GD0TFG plans to travel to Heysham on the Thursday and attend both days, returning on the Sunday.
- John can offer one place in his camper for the journey.
- Any club members wishing to share a car journey are welcome to make arrangements.

Any Other Business

VHF/UHF Contest Seminar – proposed talk for October or November (date to be confirmed):

- Do's and don'ts of VHF/UHF contesting.
- Contesting software overview.
- Minos logging software.

Next Meeting

Friday, 11th September 2026 at 19:30BST.

The Meeting closed at 20:29BST.